The truck driver and an assistant got down to fix the problem. But Sivarasan mistook that as part of the police operation and opened fire. The neighbour's bathroom, from where policemen were watching, was sprayed with AK-47 bullets. The police and the NSG commandos returned fire. In exchange, a commando and a police officer sustained grievous bullet injuries. They were rushed to the hospital. The firing stopped after thirty minutes.

The truck incident had sparked a shootout even as whatever semblance of order was left crumbled. And with the news of the firing spreading from the wireless sets in the Jaya Nagar police station, there was panic at the top. Kaarthikeyan was heard screaming on the wireless, 'Where is Captain Ravi? Where is he?' The site of action turned even more chaotic. Floodlights were switched on, paramedics arrived at the door of the house, fire engines switched on their ignitions and the public address system told the entire Bangalore police force to be on standby. A team from Doordarshan was also recording the action live. A loud gunshot was heard. The NSG thought that the fugitive had again started firing from his AK-47—but it was the sound of Sivarasan shooting himself in the head. Kaarthikeyan came out with a statement for the press even before Sivarasan's body could be officially inspected. He said, 'The SIT was criticized for being too rash during the Indira Nagar raids. So we decided to wait and do our best to catch Sivarasan alive.' The best, unfortunately, was far from good enough.[11]

The fresh cyanide antidotes arrived the next morning around 5 a.m. No one understood what took fourteen hours for the kits to travel from Gwalior to Bangalore, despite having special planes and helicopters to do the job. At 6 a.m., the NSG finally raided the house. All seven fugitives—Sivarasan, Shubha, Driver Anna, Jamuna, Nero, Amman and Suresh Master—were found dead inside.

Sivarasan had a bullet wound on his temple. The rest had bitten cyanide capsules on a day that happened to be Rajiv Gandhi's birthday. It was a botched-up operation. Too many cooks had spoilt the broth, yet so many security officials were jostling for media attention, trying to take credit for